



MASABA GUPTA

36, Founder & Creative Head—House of Masaba and LoveChild

EYES ON LUXE

MASABA GUPTA MAKES it to BT's MPW list for the third year running. She has been working on revamping the brand image of her fashion label House of Masaba (where Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail holds 51% stake) and cosmetics label LoveChild. She plans to move her apparel business towards luxury and beauty brand towards a mix of luxury and affordable luxury. "We're venturing into a category that is very exciting for India... luxury," she says. Gupta says consumers in India want to try home-grown brands. She plans to have a larger offline retail footprint for her clothing line, and revamp her ready-to-wear line. **BT**

— BY RIDDHIMA BHATNAGAR

ADVICE TO YOUNGER SELF

Stay calm and be focussed on your peace

MANTRA FOR CHALLENGES

Don't take things personally; give things time

PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH



MONIKA SHERGILL

50, Vice President, Content, Netflix India

FINGER ON THE PULSE OF INDIA

LAST YEAR WAS a blockbuster one for Netflix India; the OTT platform also won numerous accolades (including an Oscar for *The Elephant Whisperers*). Things have looked good this year as well. India has emerged as the second-largest market in terms of new paid subscribers added in April-June period. Netflix added 2.83 million

subscribers from the APAC region, including India, in this period.

Spearheading the India story is Monika Shergill. She believes that effectively leading an OTT platform requires consistently keeping the audience at the centre of every decision. "Over the years, a key to our success has been bringing the best creative voices on

the service and building a strong local team that partnered with them on delivering resonant stories while continuously pushing creative boundaries," says Shergill, a former journalist and documentary filmmaker. "I've always been passionate about stories and finding opportunities to tell them for a new, more immersive medium."

Going ahead, driving creative excellence through innovation will remain Netflix's primary focus. "This commitment is evident in our upcoming lineup, which includes *Rakt Brahmand*,

WHY SHE MATTERS

Despite India being a highly competitive and price-sensitive market, she has helped Netflix India create its own space by the sheer dint of its content

our first action-fantasy series; *Sikandar Ka Muqaddar*, a gripping crime drama from the house of Neeraj Pandey; *Vijay 69*, a slice-of-life film; and *The Royals*, a modern-day rom-com centred around Indian royalty," she says.

Shergill says the future of steaming platforms is defined by accessibility and powerful storytelling, reflecting diverse cultures and experiences. "Regional films, in particular, have seen tremendous success across India this year, underscoring the strength of local storytelling," says Shergill. **BT**

— BY ASTHA ORIEL